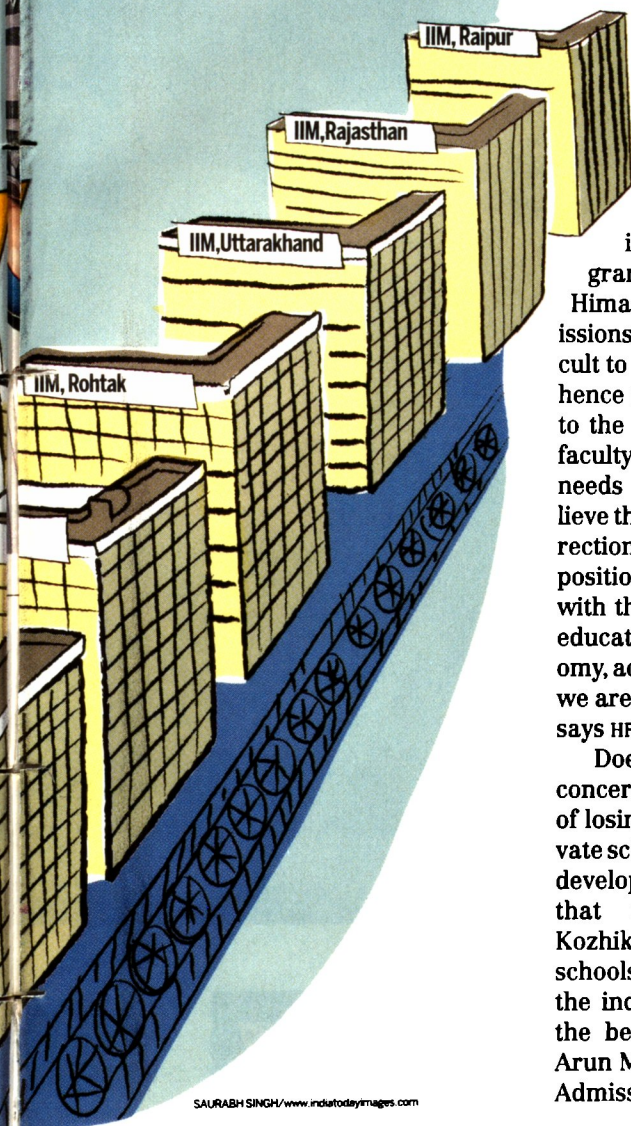


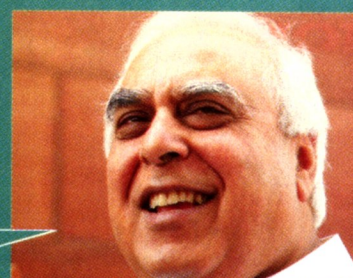


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dence. The faculty has rejected the latest proposals of the ministry on pay scales and autonomy describing them as infringement on academic freedom. "We don't accept the orders and have asked the director to postpone its implementation by a month," says an IIM-A professor.

The faculty crunch has been squeezing the IIMs and they have to do with a limited number of teachers or by inviting their alumni. The problem has become acute with the significant increase in the size of the academic programmes in the last few years. Himanshu Rai, chairman, admissions, IIM-Lucknow, says, "It is difficult to add to the faculty strength and hence the issue of supplying teachers to the new IIMs comes up. The fresh faculty is not always conducive to the needs of the programmes. But I believe the ministry's intent is in right direction." The existing IIMs are not in a position to share faculty resources with the new IIMs. "To bolster higher education and bring in more autonomy, accountability and transparency, we are reviewing all the procedures," says HRD Minister Kapil Sibal.

Does the advent of more IIMs spell concern for private B-schools in terms of losing their rank? Most of the private schools consider it to be a healthy development. "Present rankings show that IIM Shillong, Indore and Kozhikode are still below private B-schools. There is a fair competition in the industry and whoever performs the best will be highlighted," says Arun Mohan Sherry, chairman, Joint Admission Committee, IMT Group of



"To bolster higher education and bring in more autonomy, accountability and transparency, we are reviewing the procedures."

KAPIL SIBAL, HRD Minister



"The B-schools would need to focus on the intellectual capital and recruit and retain qualified faculty with focus on research and training"

FR E. ABRAHAM, S.J., director, XLRI

Institutes, Ghaziabad. But XLRI Director Fr E. Abraham, S.J. believes that the rankings of other schools will go down eventually because of the new entrants in the field with the brand name of IIM.

Educationists maintain that if IIMs maintain the same quality then there is nothing to worry about and the new ones will lead to a holistic development of students in the country. ■



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